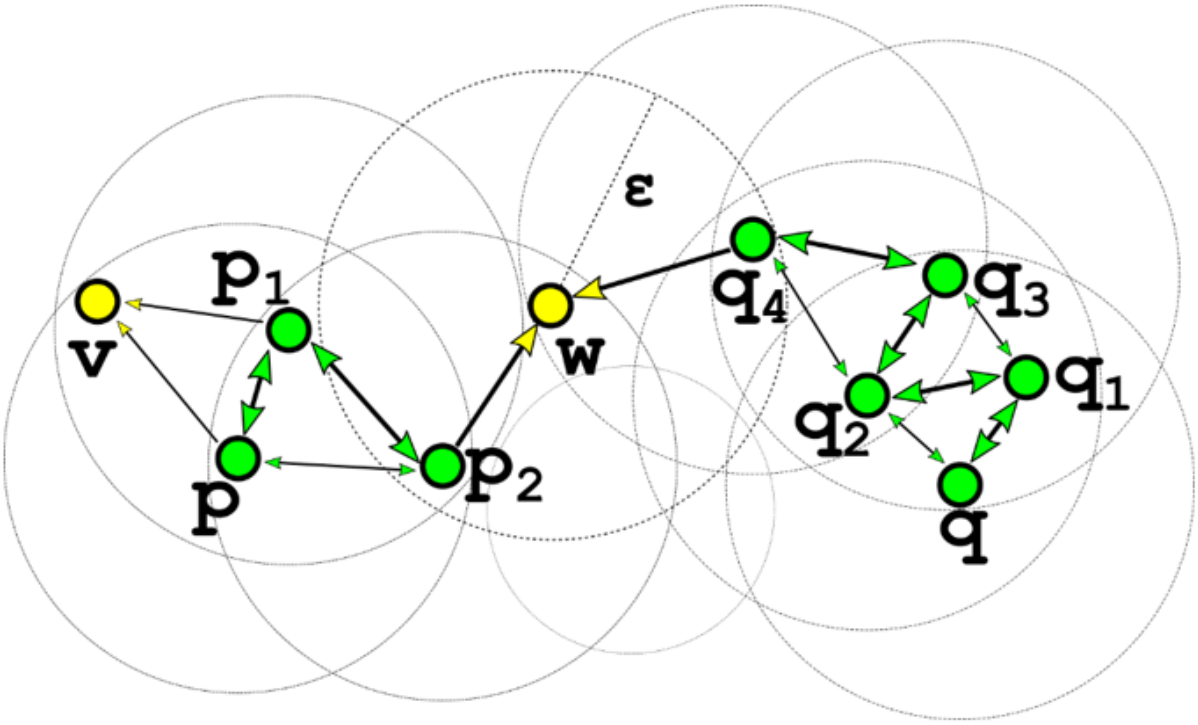


Figure 12.11 An edge point `w` is directly reachable from at least 2 different clusters. In this example, `minPoints` is set to `4`; the path from `q` to `p` is highlighted with thicker arrows.

If, instead, we process the neighbors of each core point `p` *right after* finishing with `p`, as it's shown in figure 12.10, then we can just build clusters in a sequence, growing each cluster point by point until no further point can be added to it, without any need of merging clusters or keeping track of the history of merges.

By following this order, points like `q` and `p` in the example in figure 12.11 will never be added to the same cluster, and it doesn't really matter to which of them a (so-called) *edge point* like `w` is merged: as a matter of fact, edge points are the only points for which DBSCAN is not entirely